

The core thesis

Rebecca Spooner's curriculum is the creative and pedagogical heart of the partnership. Saltbox is the infrastructure that delivers it — on the kitchen table, on the TV, on an airplane, on a borrowed device in a remote community. The combination is a curriculum ecosystem no competitor can replicate because it requires both the artistry and the technology. Rebecca's work is what families see. Saltbox is invisible until it is missing.

WHAT IS ALREADY BUILT — THE CAPABILITY INVENTORY



The interactive catalog mockup — 20+ paths, 7 real GR covers, full lesson sequences, expandable activity break prompts verbatim from her printed curriculum — was built from cover images and PDF tables of contents in a single session. The Advent TV display (five audio sessions, lit candles, falling snow) was built the same way. Each major Gather Round unit can become a screen-filling ambient experience that plays in the home before, during, and after the school day. This is not a feature list. It is a demonstration that one person with this toolset can deliver what would take Gather Round a four-person product team six months to ship.

THE THREE PARTNERSHIP VECTORS

A — Tech Retainer (earliest, lowest barrier)

Rebecca's open job postings are the entry point. The capabilities already built — app development, curriculum integration, visual experience design, offline infrastructure — map directly to roles she is trying to hire. A retainer arrangement means she gets a senior full-stack curriculum technologist on demand, without the overhead of a full-time hire. The contribution is ten times what a single hire would produce because the toolset compounds across every unit.

B — Co-brand (year one, alongside retainer)

Saltbox is positioned as the official offline companion for Gather Round families — endorsed by Rebecca, distributed through her channels, branded as "Saltbox — the Gather Round companion." No revenue exchange in year one. The goal is adoption data: families citing offline access and the portfolio layer as a reason for their Legacy Pass purchase or renewal.

C — Acquisition (year two or three, data-backed)

Once co-brand data exists — retention lift, new Legacy Pass sales attributable to Saltbox, families sharing portfolio exports as social proof — the conversation shifts to acquisition. Gather Round acquires Saltbox and the builder joins as the technology lead. The pitch: you built the curriculum; you now own the platform that delivers it. No competitor can separate the two.

THE ARTISTRY PRINCIPLE — NON-NEGOTIABLE IN EVERY CONVERSATION

In every meeting, every proposal, every demo: Rebecca's artistic vision is the headline. Saltbox is the stage, not the show. The Africa unit display leads with her imagery. The Advent experience leads with her audio. The portfolio exports lead with the child's work, not the app's chrome. This framing is strategic — it makes the partnership easy for her to say yes to — and it is also simply true. The technology is only worth anything because the curriculum underneath it is extraordinary.

WHAT "10X HER TEAM'S OUTPUT" MEANS CONCRETELY

Curriculum app four-person product team, 6–12 months, \$350K+ — or one retainer, one session per unit.

TV experiences agency creative + developer, \$15–30K per unit — or built in hours with existing audio files.

Portfolio evidence custom dev work — or live in Saltbox today, families already using it.

Legacy Pass integration blockchain developer + months of testing — or already live, zero server involvement.

Offline access native app development — or Saltbox, which runs on a \$50 tablet with no connection.

REVENUE MODEL OPTIONS

Year 1: No cash exchange. Saltbox is free for all Legacy Pass holders. Gather Round endorses publicly.

Year 2: Retainer fee for ongoing development + unit TV experiences. Scope: 2–3 units per quarter.

Trigger: If Legacy Pass sales grow and Saltbox is a cited reason, revenue share negotiation opens.

Acquisition: Technology + builder. Structure TBD — equity, earn-out, or flat acquisition against proven ARR lift.

CONTRIBUTION TO HER OPEN ROLES

Do not wait for the acquisition conversation. Engage with her open positions now — not as a candidate, but as a retainer partner who can do the work those roles require without the overhead. Each posting is an open door into her operational needs. The correct framing: "I can contribute to what this role would do, starting now."

Curriculum tech integration

Interactive experience design

Community digital engagement

Content delivery infrastructure